

M02 PROTECTED PRACTICE REVIEW

Open only after a genuine saved attempt

Repair -> close this file -> changed retry -> append evidence.

EFA1 review - IF, IFS and Logical Tests

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

The formula matches the written business rule, boundary cases are tested manually, missing/cancelled cases are deliberately handled, and copied formulas remain row-correct.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Promised Date E2 and Actual Date F2: =IF(F2<=E2,"On Time","Late"). For score bands: =IFS(D2>=90,"A",D2>=75,"B",D2>=60,"C",TRUE,"D"). Test exactly 90, 75 and 60.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If the formula becomes deeply nested, rewrite the rule in plain language and use helper columns or IFS. If exactly-at-cutoff cases fail, inspect >= versus > and rule order.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA2 review - SUMIFS, COUNTIFS and AVERAGEIFS

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

All criteria/sum/average ranges cover identical source rows; text/date/number criteria match stored types; one result reconciles to a filtered/manual check.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Total selected Region + Category: =SUMIFS(Sales,Region,\$J\$7,Category,\$J\$8). Count selected Region above threshold: =COUNTIFS(Region,\$J\$7,Sales,">="&\$J\$11). Validate by filtering.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If a result is zero unexpectedly, inspect spaces/case/data types and criteria operators. If ranges differ in size, correct the design rather than expanding blindly.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA3 review - Cleaning Text and Inconsistent Values

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Raw columns remain recoverable; clean outputs are explainable; duplicate logic uses the intended key/grain; source row count changes only when a justified action is documented.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

For raw name " riya sharma ", use =PROPER(TRIM(B2)) in a clean helper. For Customer ID duplicates, use COUNTIF against the ID column before deciding whether deletion is justified.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If cleanup changes IDs or meaning, revert to raw and isolate the transformation. If Remove Duplicates seems tempting, first state exactly which column combination defines a duplicate.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA4 review - Text Extraction and Date Analysis

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Extraction matches the documented pattern; real dates sort/arithmetic correctly; date-looking text is not silently forced; the fixed practice date makes the result reproducible.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

For INV-2026-00481, =LEFT(A2,3) returns INV. With a real Order Date, =YEAR(B2), =MONTH(B2) and =EOMONTH(B2,0) create stable date attributes.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If a positional formula returns nonsense, check whether source format varies. If date math fails, inspect stored type/value before applying formatting or DATEVALUE.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA5 review - Lookups: XLOOKUP First, Compatibility Second

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Master key uniqueness is checked, not-found count is visible, enriched row count remains stable, and at least one returned value is manually verified against the master.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

=XLOOKUP(B7,Products!\$A\$2:\$A\$9,Products!\$B\$2:\$B\$9,"Not Found") returns Product. Repeat for Category and Standard Price. Check Product ID uniqueness first.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If values look plausible but wrong, inspect duplicate master keys and lookup/return ranges. Do not wrap unresolved #N/A in IFERROR("",...) just to make the sheet look clean.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA6 review - Error Handling without Hiding Problems

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Each error's cause is identified; fallbacks preserve business meaning; unresolved data-quality/reference defects remain discoverable; no catch-all hides critical problems.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Average Order Value = Sales/Orders may use a deliberate N/A/blank rule when Orders=0. A missing Product ID from XLOOKUP should normally remain visible as Not Found rather than silently blank.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If every error becomes blank, remove blanket IFERROR and inspect each case. If #REF! appears after structural edits, repair the reference rather than masking it.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA7 review - Data Quality Controls in Excel

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Every control has a stated business rule and grain; invalid rows are counted; input validation works; a trusted count/total reconciles before and after any justified repair.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

If Order ID must be unique: =COUNTIF(Orders[Order ID],[@[Order ID]])>1 flags repeated IDs. Data Validation can restrict Status input to Closed/Pending. Reconcile total Net Sales to a trusted control total.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If a control flags valid repeated values, revisit grain/key definition. If a dropdown breaks, inspect its source range/reference before retyping values manually.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA8 review - PivotTables for Business Questions

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Correct source/Table is used, aggregation is deliberately chosen, filters are visible, refresh works, and at least one Pivot total reconciles to source.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

From one-call-per-row source, Customer in Rows + Call ID Count answers calls by customer. For Value, confirm Sum; for Satisfaction, Average may be meaningful. Reconcile a grand total to source.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If a numeric field defaults to Count, inspect blanks/type. If totals differ, clear filters, verify source range/Table expansion and compare the aggregation/grain.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA9 review - PivotCharts, Slicers and Report Design

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Chart type fits question, slicer connections are correct, KPI/Pivot/chart remain consistent through filter states, titles are meaningful and no visual exaggeration/3D is used.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Create monthly call-count PivotTable, add a line PivotChart, add Representative slicer, test default/filter/clear states and confirm chart/Pivot totals stay consistent.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If visuals disagree, validate the underlying Pivot before formatting. If slicer affects the wrong view, inspect Report Connections. If a sentence claims cause, rewrite as observed pattern.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA10 review - Power Query: Import, Transform, Load and Refresh

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Applied Steps are readable, types are deliberate, row-count/total changes are explained, raw source remains untouched, refresh updates automatically and output reconciles where definitions match.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Load a source range, promote headers if needed, set types deliberately, Trim/Clean text, replace a justified known value, split/filter/add conditional column, then Close & Load and Refresh after a source change.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If a later step breaks, locate the first failing Applied Step and inspect renamed/removed columns or type assumptions. If row count changes unexpectedly, stop and explain before continuing.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

EFA11 review - Relationships and the Excel Data Model (Strong Fresher)

1. What a strong attempt should demonstrate

Grain is stated for both tables, intended one-side key is unique, relationship direction/cardinality is correctly explained, and no DAX mastery is assumed.

2. Expected reasoning / worked pattern

Sales contains many P104 rows; Products should contain one P104. Product ID connects many Sales rows to one Products row. Two P104 rows in Products break the intended one-side uniqueness.

3. What to compare in your workbook

Compare the business rule/grain first, then the exact formula/query/Pivot/relationship, then one independent check. Do not compare only the final number. If your result differs but your logic is valid on changed data, validate the logic rather than copying this example.

4. Likely repair

If relationship creation fails, inspect data types, blanks and duplicate keys on the one side. Do not “fix” duplicate dimension keys by arbitrary deletion without investigating entity meaning.

5. Fresh retry rule

Close this review. Use changed criteria/data/context. Reproduce the competency without reopening the lesson/review. Append the retry as new evidence. Only the changed retry can upgrade mastery.

M-XLA project review - defend, do not copy

1. Expected architecture

Untouched raw sources -> Prepared_Data -> Analysis_Pivots -> Management_Report -> Validation_Log. Unknown/not-found values remain visible until investigated.

2. Validation contract

Prepared rows reconcile to raw/rejected logic; enrichment has visible not-found checks; at least two important totals/counts reconcile; report metrics share definitions; findings are supported by evidence and limitations are stated.

3. If the report cannot be defended

If the report looks finished but cannot be defended, trace backward: visual -> Pivot -> prepared metric -> transformation -> raw grain. Repair the earliest incorrect step and rerun validations.

4. Fresh retry

Change the business dataset or affected component. Close this review, rebuild the weak piece, rerun downstream validations and append the new evidence before Gate A.